

IT SUPPORT KNOWLEDGE BASE

Phase 08: Documentation

Professional End-User & Service Desk Reference

Document ID: P07-DOC-KB-001 | Version: 1.0 | Owner: IT Support Team | Classification: Internal Use

Purpose:

Provide standardized, reusable troubleshooting articles for common workplace IT incidents and service requests.

1. How to Use the Knowledge Base

Select the article that best matches the reported symptom. Follow the checks in order, stop when the issue is resolved, and document the article ID and actions in the support ticket. Do not perform privileged or destructive actions outside approved procedures.

Article ID	Topic	Typical Audience
KB-001	Password and account access	All users / Service Desk
KB-002	Network connectivity	All users / Service Desk
KB-003	Wi-Fi connectivity	All users / Service Desk
KB-004	Slow workstation	All users / Service Desk
KB-005	Low disk space	Service Desk
KB-006	Application not responding	Service Desk
KB-007	Application error	Service Desk
KB-008	Access denied	Service Desk / IT Admin
KB-009	Printer problem	Service Desk
KB-010	Remote access failure	Service Desk / IT Admin
KB-011	Email problem	Service Desk
KB-012	Linux service issue	IT Support / IT Admin
KB-013	Suspicious file or phishing	All users / Security
KB-014	Lost or stolen device	All users / IT Support

2. Standard Troubleshooting Rules

- Verify the user and understand the business impact before making changes.
- Capture the exact symptoms or error message.
- Determine whether the issue affects one user/device or multiple users.
- Check recent changes and obvious conditions first.
- Use the least disruptive approved action.
- Never request or record passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or other authentication secrets.
- Verify the result after remediation.

- Document unresolved issues and escalate with evidence.

3. KB-001: Password or Account Access Problem

When to Use

Use when a user cannot sign in, believes a password has expired, or needs an approved password reset.

Procedure

1. Verify the user's identity using the approved process.
2. Determine whether the problem is password-related, account-disabled, or service-related.
3. Check the account status using authorized administration tools.
4. Perform an approved password reset or unlock if authorized.
5. Require the user to create a compliant password when applicable.
6. Confirm successful authentication.
7. Record the resolution without recording the password.

Escalate When

- Repeated authentication failure after reset
- Account remains disabled
- Suspected account compromise

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

4. KB-002: No Network Connectivity

When to Use

Use when a workstation cannot reach the corporate network.

Procedure

1. Check physical Ethernet or approved wireless connection.
2. Confirm the network adapter is enabled.
3. Review IP address, gateway, and DNS configuration.
4. Test connectivity to the local gateway.
5. Test an approved internal destination.
6. Determine whether other users are affected.
7. Restart the network connection only when appropriate.

Escalate When

- Multiple users affected
- Gateway or infrastructure unreachable
- Network equipment appears unavailable

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

5. KB-003: Wi-Fi Connectivity

When to Use

Use for intermittent or failed wireless connectivity.

Procedure

1. Confirm the user is within the expected coverage area.
2. Confirm the correct approved wireless network is selected.
3. Check whether other devices can connect.
4. Reconnect to the approved network.
5. Check signal quality and basic IP configuration.
6. Escalate persistent coverage or authentication problems.

Escalate When

- Multiple users affected
- Repeated authentication failure
- Suspected access-point or infrastructure issue

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

6. KB-004: Slow Workstation

When to Use

Use when a workstation is unusually slow.

Procedure

1. Ask when the slowdown began.
2. Check CPU, memory, disk utilization, and active processes.
3. Close unnecessary applications.
4. Check available storage.
5. Restart the affected application or workstation when appropriate.
6. Review recent updates or changes.
7. Escalate if performance remains abnormal.

Escalate When

- Critical application impacted
- Hardware fault suspected
- Repeated performance degradation

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

7. KB-005: Low Disk Space

When to Use

Use when the operating system reports insufficient storage.

Procedure

1. Confirm available capacity.
2. Identify large approved temporary or cache data.
3. Remove only files permitted by policy.
4. Empty approved recycle/trash locations.
5. Recheck capacity.
6. Escalate if capacity remains critically low or business data may be affected.

Escalate When

- Critical storage threshold
- Unknown large files
- Possible data loss

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

8. KB-006: Application Not Responding

When to Use

Use when an application freezes, hangs, or stops responding.

Procedure

1. Allow a reasonable period if the application may be processing a task.
2. Check whether the issue affects only one application.
3. Save work if possible.
4. Close and reopen the application when appropriate.
5. Check application/system status and approved logs.
6. Test the application again.
7. Document any unsaved-work impact.

Escalate When

- Repeated crashes
- Multiple users affected
- Possible data corruption

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

9. KB-007: Application Error

When to Use

Use when an application displays an error message.

Procedure

1. Capture the exact error message without exposing sensitive data.
2. Record application name and version.
3. Check whether the issue is reproducible.
4. Review approved application logs.
5. Check known configuration or service dependencies.
6. Apply the approved fix or update.
7. Verify normal operation.

Escalate When

- Security-related error
- License/service issue
- Recurring error after remediation

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

10. KB-008: Access Denied

When to Use

Use when a user cannot access a file, application, folder, or service.

Procedure

1. Verify the user's identity.
2. Confirm the exact resource requested.
3. Confirm business need and approval.
4. Check account status, group membership, and effective permissions using authorized tools.
5. Apply the minimum required permission.
6. Test access.
7. Document approval and change.

Escalate When

- No business justification
- Privileged access requested
- Permission change affects many users

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

11. KB-009: Printer Problem

When to Use

Use for unavailable, offline, queued, or failed-printing issues.

Procedure

1. Confirm printer name/location.
2. Check power, connectivity, and visible status.
3. Check whether other users can print.
4. Review of the local print queue.
5. Retry with a small test document.
6. Restart the approved print service/device only when authorized.
7. Escalate infrastructure or hardware failures.

Escalate When

- Multiple users affected
- Hardware fault
- Print server unavailable

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

12. KB-010: Remote Access Failure

When to Use

Use when authorized remote access to a workstation or service fails.

Procedure

1. Confirm the target hostname/address and approved access method.
2. Verify the remote service is available.
3. Check connectivity to the target.
4. Review relevant service status and logs.
5. Test using an authorized account.
6. Do not disable security controls merely to obtain access.
7. Document the failure and escalate when required.

Escalate When

- Repeated authentication failure
- Service unavailable
- Firewall/network restriction suspected

Ticket Documentation

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13. KB-011: Email Problem

When to Use

Use for sign-in, sending, receiving, or synchronization issues.

Procedure

1. Confirm whether the problem affects web, desktop, or mobile access.
2. Check account status.
3. Confirm network connectivity.
4. Check mailbox/service status through approved tools.
5. Record exact error messages.
6. Test a controlled send/receive operation.
7. Escalate suspected service-wide outages.

Escalate When

- Multiple users affected
- Account compromise suspected
- Service outage

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

14. KB-012: Linux Service Issue

When to Use

Use for authorized Linux service troubleshooting.

Procedure

1. Identify the actual service name.
2. Check service status with `systemctl`.
3. Review recent service-specific logs with `journalctl`.
4. Determine whether the service is active, failed, or stopped.
5. Restart only an authorized non-critical service when appropriate.
6. Verify the service after remediation.
7. Document the observed state and result.

Escalate When

- Service repeatedly fails
- Production-critical service
- Configuration change requires elevated approval

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

15. KB-013: Suspicious File or Phishing

When to Use

Use when a user receives a suspicious email, attachment, link, or unexpected executable.

Procedure

1. Tell the user not to open or interact further with the suspicious content.
2. Record sender, subject, timestamp, and other relevant non-sensitive evidence.
3. Do not forward malicious content outside approved security procedures.
4. Escalate to the security/IT administration team.
5. Follow the organization's incident-response procedure.
6. Preserve evidence as instructed.
7. Document user impact and actions taken.

Escalate When

- Credentials may have been entered
- Malware suspected
- Multiple users received the message

Ticket Documentation

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16. KB-014: Lost or Stolen Device

When to Use

Use for lost, stolen, or missing company equipment.

Procedure

1. Confirm the asset identifier and assigned user.
2. Record when and where the device was last known to be present.
3. Notify the appropriate IT/security contact immediately.
4. Follow approved account/session revocation procedures.
5. Do not attempt unauthorized tracking or physical recovery.
6. Update the asset register and incident ticket.
7. Document all handoffs.

Escalate When

- Device contains sensitive data
- Theft suspected
- Authentication credentials may be exposed

Ticket Documentation

Record the article ID, observed symptoms, relevant checks, corrective action, verification result, and escalation status. Never place passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or unnecessary confidential data in the ticket.

17. Escalation Standards

Condition	Escalation Destination	Required Evidence
Widespread outage	IT Manager / Infrastructure	Scope, affected services/users, timestamps, tests performed
Security incident	Security / IT Administration	Observed indicators, timestamps, affected asset/user, preserved evidence
Privileged change required	IT Administrator	Business need, approval, requested resource/change
Hardware failure	IT Asset / Procurement	Asset ID, symptoms, diagnostic result
Data loss or recovery	IT Administration / Data Owner	Affected data/service, time discovered, actions already taken
Recurring unresolved issue	Tier 2 / Specialist	Complete troubleshooting history and verification attempts

18. Sensitive Information Handling

- Do not record passwords, authentication codes, private keys, recovery codes, or session tokens.
- Sanitize screenshots before placing them in training or general documentation.
- Do not copy confidential business files into troubleshooting evidence unless explicitly required and authorized.
- Use controlled test files for remote-transfer demonstrations.
- Store support records only in approved repositories.

19. Article Maintenance

The IT Support Team should review this knowledge base at least annually and after significant system, application, security, or support-process changes. Retire duplicate or obsolete articles and update article IDs and ownership when the knowledge base is reorganized.

20. Revision History

Version	Date	Description	Owner
1.0	2026-08-10	Initial professional knowledge base for Phase 07.	IT Support Team